

Tools to Develop Cross-Platform Mobile Apps

Trending in the mobile application development world are cross-platform mobile apps. There are a great many tools and frameworks available for this specific purpose. This article offers a selection of what the author considers the five best cross-platform app development tools. A word of caution though—some of these tools come with certain strings attached.



With the increasing number of smartphones and tablets being used all over the world, mobile app development is becoming a major attraction among technologists, developers, enterprises and even everyday users. Android and iOS have become the main platforms for smartphones. With the aim of providing all sorts of services and improving business processes, companies today focus on creating the most effective and easy-to-use applications on smartphones.

The current requirements for mobile application development are cross-platform tools (CPTs), which enable developers to build apps that can be supported on both Android and iOS platforms.

Today, we have numerous CPTs available, but every development platform has its pros and cons. Ultimately, which CPT the developer chooses depends on the needs and goals of the app-based business.

Popular open source CPTs available are Sencha Touch, PhoneGap (Apache Cordova), Appcelerator Titanium, Qt and Xamarin SDK.

Let us delve deeper into these tools to get an idea of their unique features.

Sencha Touch

Sencha Touch is an open source cross-platform mobile app development tool written in JavaScript. It supports development on all platforms like Android, iOS, BlackBerry, Kindle, Windows Phone and Tizen. It is a user interface JavaScript library or framework built specially for the mobile Web. It is used to develop GUIs for mobile Web applications, making the apps look like native applications on mobile devices. Sencha Touch is a product of Sencha, which was formed after popular JavaScript library projects Ext JS, jQueryTouch and Raphael were combined. It offers an MVC style architecture, an extensible API, a vast UI component library and several UI themes that can be used with the Sencha native packager and also PhoneGap.

Its features are listed below.

- **Faster layouts:** The layout components are faster and, in turn, make apps run faster. The orientation of the layout is highly attractive and advanced.
- **Cordova support:** Supports Apache Cordova APIs for the accelerometer, camera, capture, compass, connections, contacts, device, events, files, geolocation, InAppBrowser, media, notifications and storage.